Brainiac: Forensics - Beginner

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Description

Players get a text file of ritual-looking symbols, which is actually Brainfuck. Running it through a free interpreter reveals a base64-encoded string, which decodes to the flag. Real flag-printing code is interleaved with harmless decoy loops, adding a light extra layer of tracing the tape to spot noise from signal.

Github Path: Path to github once it has been added to the repo

Prompt

Deep in the archives of an abandoned research lab, you find a single scrap of parchment covered in strange runes. The lab's last notes mention a 'tongue only machines can speak.' Whatever secret this tape holds, it won't reveal itself to the human eye.

Download: [DOWNLOAD LINK]

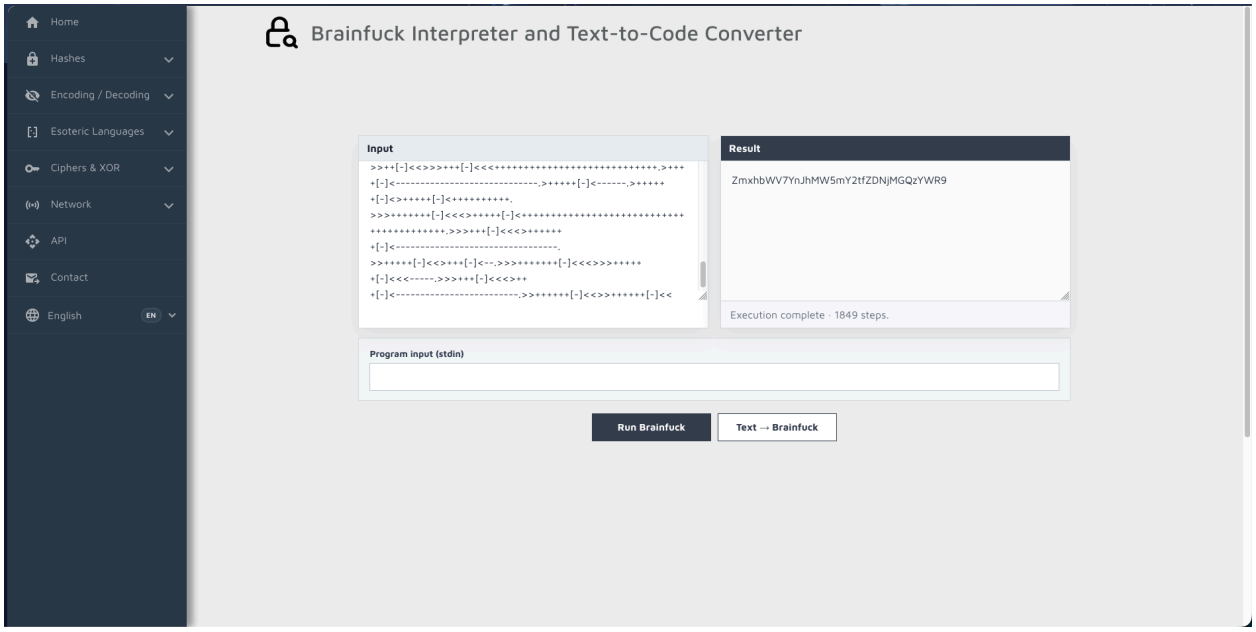
Hints

1. This tape only uses a handful of symbols, over and over. That repetition is the real clue, somewhere out there, a dead-simple programming language uses exactly this symbol set.
2. You're looking at Brainfuck. Any free interpreter online can decipher this tape. Try it, what does it say?
3. What the tape speaks isn't quite the words you're looking for, it's a well-known encoding of them, not plain text.

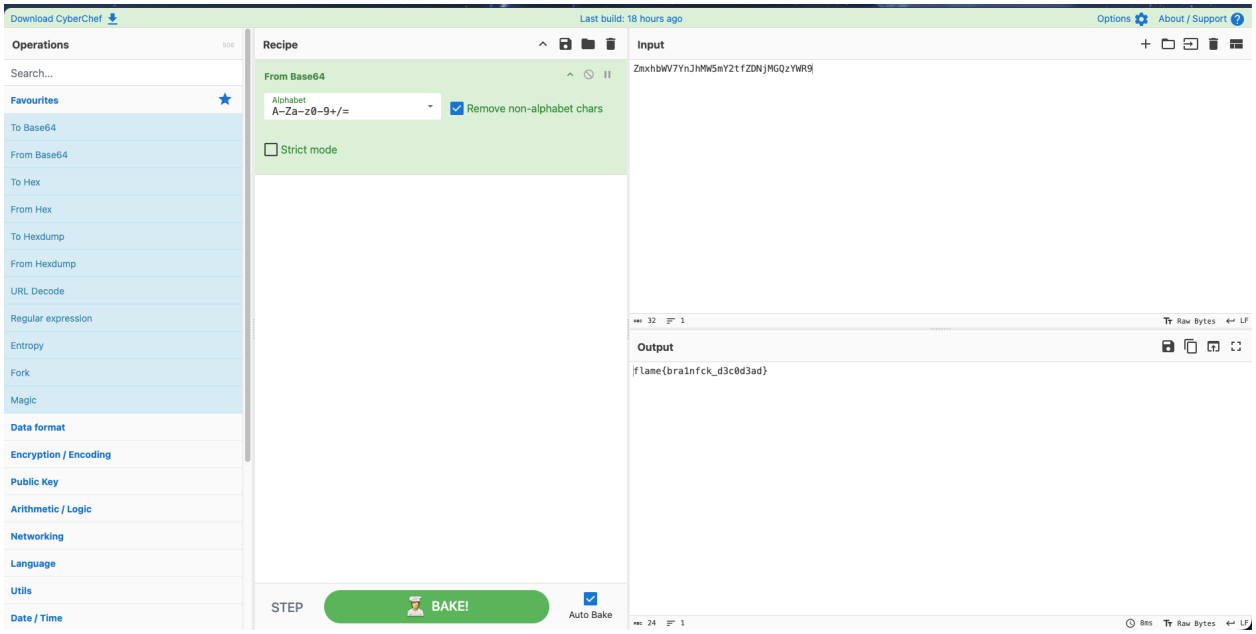
Solution

Recognize the symbol set as Brainfuck
– +/- increment/decrement the current memory cell
/< move the pointer,
. prints the current cell as a character
[...] loops while the current cell is nonzero.

1. Run the file through any standard Brainfuck interpreter (plenty of free ones online) exactly as given.



2. Running the file prints a base64-looking string, not the flag directly. Recognize the base64 character set/padding and decode it (any online base64 decoder, `base64 -d`, or Python's `base64.b64decode`) to reveal the actual flag.



Flag

flame{bra1nfck_d3c0d3ad}